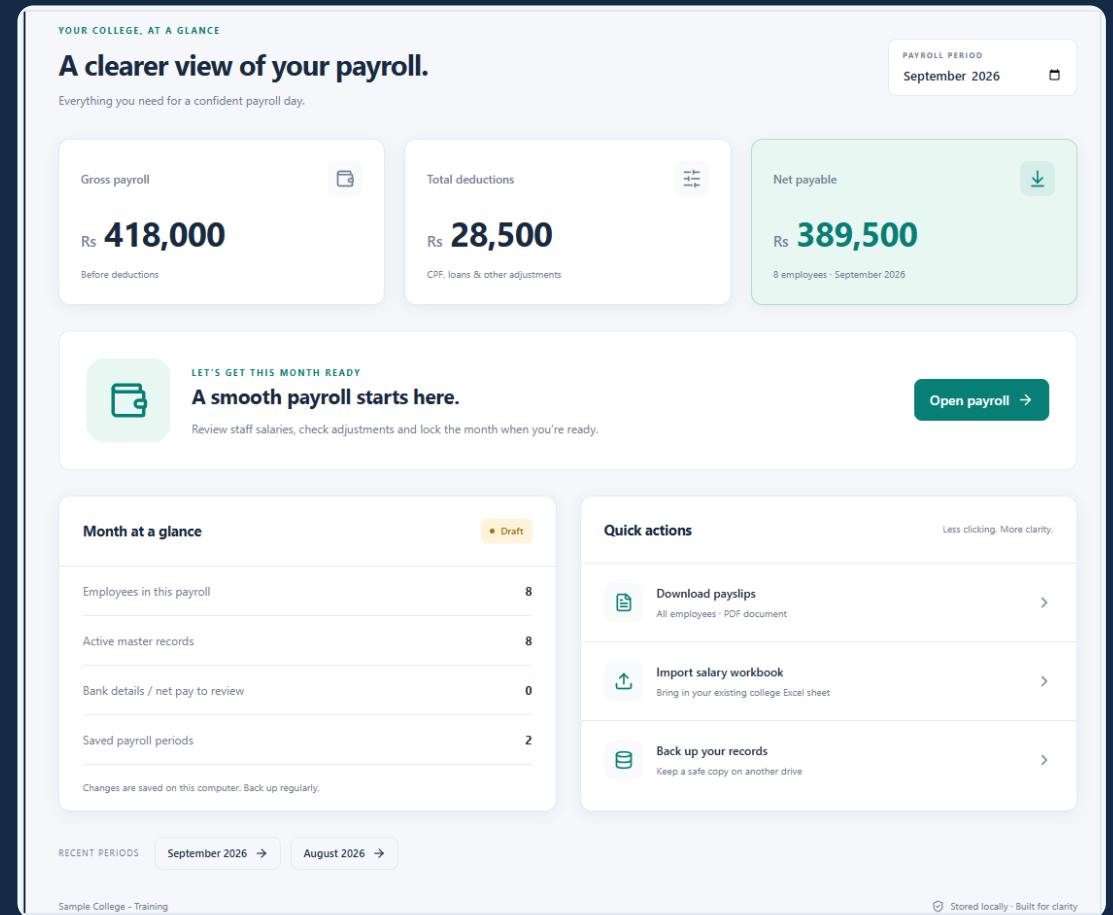


PAYROLL DESK

Your visual user guide.

Simple English. Real screenshots.
Numbered arrows for every main task.



DESKTOP EDITION 1.0 | SEPTEMBER 2026

Open it. Find the button. Follow the steps.

Find what you need

Click a topic below to jump to it. The same page numbers work in a printed copy.

03 First launch and the monthly routine

04 Dashboard: navigation and totals

05 Dashboard: quick actions

06 Employees: search, add and edit

07 Employee master: personal details

08 Employee master: bank and salary

09 Import an Excel salary workbook

10 Payroll: month and main buttons

11 Read the salary table

12 Edit one month only

13 Working days and salary inputs

14 Understand the salary calculation

15 Lock and unlock a month

16 Download the right report

17 Save, open and print a file

18 General settings and college logo

19 BPS scales and allowances

20 Email setup and sending payslips

21 Backup, restore and another PC

22 Light and dark appearance

23 Salary words in plain English

24 Monthly checklist and quick fixes

How to read an arrow: match its number to the explanation below or beside the screenshot. All people and account details shown are examples.

Start with a simple routine

Use the desktop shortcut. You do not need to open a browser or type commands.

1 Open Payroll Desk

After installation, double-click Payroll Desk on the desktop.

In this project folder, Run Payroll.cmd also opens the new application.

2 Check the month

The app normally opens the current month. Use Payroll period to choose the month you need.

An older saved month is not opened automatically.

3 Prepare the records

Check employee details, BPS scales and college settings. Add staff manually or import the college salary workbook.

4 Review the payroll

Enter this month's days, arrears and deductions. Click Save changes, then review gross, deductions and net pay.

5 Lock and download

When the figures are correct, lock the month. Save the payslips and the statements you need.

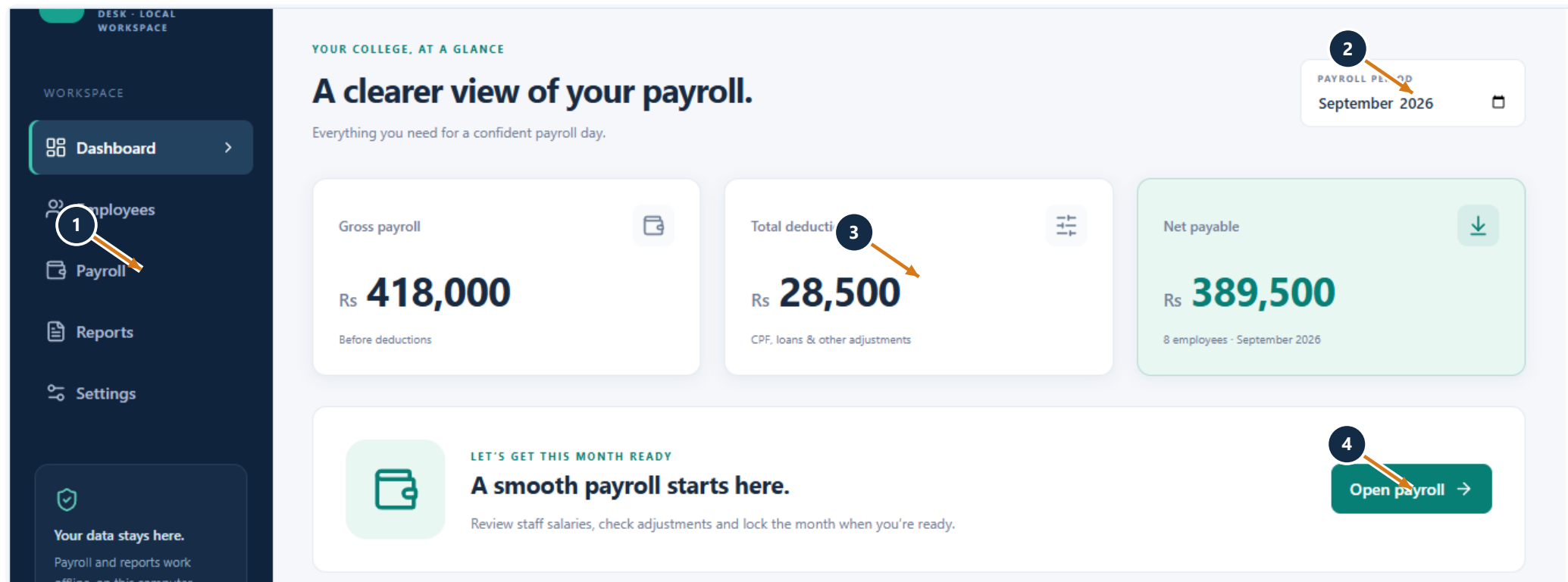
6 Make a backup

Save a database backup to another drive. Keep the backup private.

Core payroll works offline. Only email needs internet.

Dashboard: your starting point

This screen gives a summary of the selected month. It does not pay money to anyone.

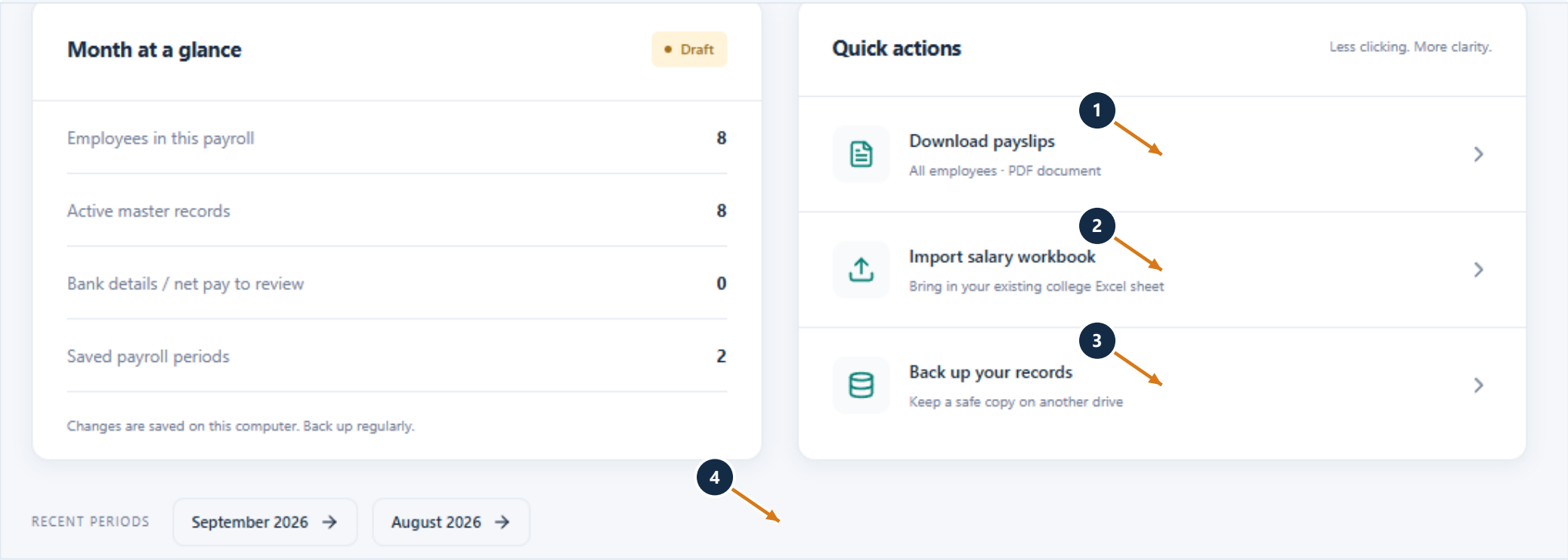


- 1 Navigation menu - Open Dashboard, Employees, Payroll, Reports or Settings.
- 2 Payroll period - Choose the month and year before working on salary.
- 3 Salary cards - Gross is before deductions. Deductions reduce pay. Net payable is the amount left.
- 4 Open payroll - Go to the detailed salary table for this month.

The totals describe the selected month. They are not a total of every month in the database.

Dashboard: useful shortcuts

Use these shortcuts for common jobs. The main pages offer the same features.



- 1

Download payslips - Opens Reports. Choose the scope, then click Save PDF.
- 2

Import salary workbook - Choose the supported college Excel workbook. See page 9 before importing.
- 3

Back up your records - Choose a folder and save a copy of the database.
- 4

Recent periods - Click a saved month to load it. The summary updates for that period.

Month at a glance: shows payroll staff, active master records, bank/net-pay issues and the number of saved periods. A review count is a prompt to check the records.

Employees: find, add and edit staff

These are master records: the usual details and pay defaults for each person.

EMPLOYEE	BPS	BASIC PAY	BANK	STATUS
AE Amina Example Lecturer	17	30,000	Sample Bank	Active >
BE Bilal Example Lecturer	17	32,000	Sample Bank	Active >
DE Dania Example Lecturer	17	34,000	Sample Bank	Active >
FE Faisal Example Lecturer	17	36,000	Sample Bank	Active >

- 1 Search - Type a name, designation or BPS grade to narrow the list.
- 2 Show inactive - Tick this to include people marked inactive.
- 3 Import Excel - Load staff and salary inputs from the supported workbook.
- 4 Add employee - Open a blank form for a new staff member.
- 5 Open a record - Click the name or the arrow at the right. Edit the form, then save.

Click supported column headings, such as Employee or Basic Pay, to change the sort order. Click again to reverse it.

Employee master: personal details

Add a new employee or open an existing employee from the list.

The screenshot shows a 'Personal details' form with the following fields and values:

- Full name:** Amina Example (Callout 1)
- Designation:** Lecturer (Callout 2)
- Appointment date:** 01.08.2024 (Callout 3)
- BPS (blank for contract):** 17 (Callout 4)
- Section:** Senior College (Callout 5)
- Category / group:** Teaching (Callout 6)

- 1 Full name - Enter the name to show on salary sheets and payslips. This field is required.
- 2 Designation - Enter the job title, for example Lecturer or Accountant.
- 3 Appointment date - Enter the date in your college's usual format, such as 01.08.2024.
- 4 BPS - Enter the pay grade. Leave it blank for a person without a BPS grade.
- 5 Section - Enter the section or department used on the payslip.
- 6 Category / group - Use a staff group, such as Teaching or Admin, for your records.

Changes in Employees are master changes. Unlocked months may use these changes if no separate monthly value is saved.

Employee master: bank and default pay

Keep account details accurate. Amounts here are the usual defaults for payroll.

The form is titled "Bank & contact details" and "Default salary". It contains the following fields and controls:

- Bank account:** Text input with value "DEMO-001".
- Bank:** Text input with value "Sample Bank".
- Email address:** Text input with value "teacher1@example.invalid".
- CPF account number:** Text input with value "CPF-001".
- CPF member:** Dropdown menu with value "Yes".
- Employee status:** Dropdown menu with value "Active".
- Running basic:** Text input with value "30000".
- Special allowance:** Text input with value "2000".

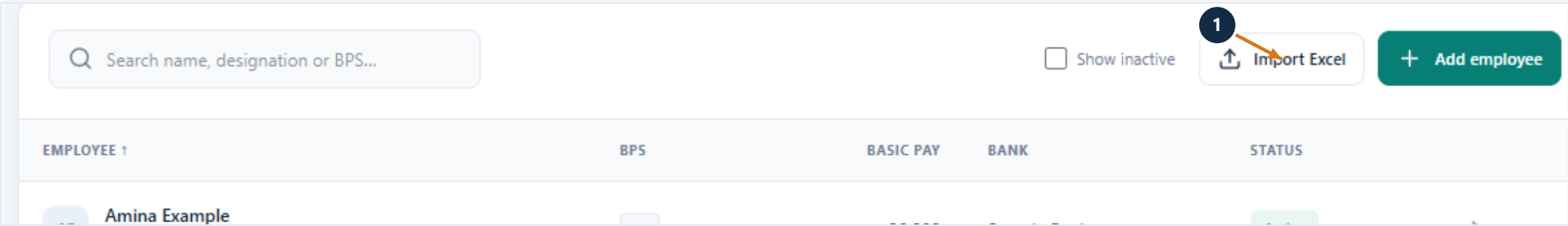
At the bottom, there are two buttons: "Close" and "Save changes".

- 1 Bank account and bank - Enter both the account number and bank name. Keep any leading zeros.
- 2 Email and CPF account - Enter the employee's email for payslips. CPF account number is used on the CPF statement.
- 3 CPF member - Choose Yes to apply the CPF deduction; choose No for a non-member.
- 4 Employee status - Inactive people are excluded from unlocked payrolls. To reactivate, show inactive staff and choose Active.
- 5 Default salary - Running basic is the base salary. Special allowance is the extra amount for this person.
- 6 Save changes - Saves the record. Close or Discard leaves the form; confirm if asked about unsaved edits.

Deactivation does not remove a person from locked historical payrolls. It can change an unlocked past month, so finalize history before changing staff status.

Import a salary workbook

Use the college salary workbook layout supported by the application.



1 Choose the workbook

Click Import Excel, read the confirmation and choose an .xlsx file.

The salary title must include Calculation of Staff Salary and a readable month/year, such as Month of August 2026.

2 Understand the update

The importer reads employees, BPS amounts and one month's salary inputs.

People are matched by name and appointment date. Matching records are updated. A safety backup is made before the live data is replaced.

3 Read the result

Check the new/updated counts, missing bank matches, similar-name matches, allowance differences and other deductions.

Open the imported month and review the affected staff before locking it.

An import into a locked month is rejected. The staged import is not applied. Unlock only if you intentionally want to change that month.

Payroll: month and main buttons

Start here for monthly salary work. Check the period before editing or exporting.

The screenshot displays the 'PAYROLL WORKSPACE' interface for 'Monthly payroll'. At the top right, a 'PAYROLL PERIOD' selector shows 'September 2026' with a calendar icon. Below this, three summary cards are shown: 'Gross payroll' at Rs 418,000 (Before deductions), 'Total deductions' at Rs 28,500 (CPF, loans & other adjustments), and 'Net payable' at Rs 389,500 (8 employees - September 2026). A search bar is located below the summary cards. At the bottom, there is a 'Draft' button, an 'Export Excel' button, a 'Save PDF' button, an 'Export scope' dropdown menu set to 'Entire month', and a 'Review & lock month' button. Numbered callouts (1-6) point to these specific elements.

- 1 Payroll period - Choose the month and year.
- 2 Search - Find a person by name, designation or BPS.
- 3 Export scope - Choose Entire month or Selected employees.
- 4 Export Excel - Save the salary register as an Excel file.
- 5 Save PDF - Save payslips for the chosen scope.
- 6 Review & lock month - Finalize the figures after you have reviewed them. See page 15.

Read the salary table

Amounts are shown in Pakistani rupees (PKR). Scroll sideways if all columns do not fit.

☐	EMPLOYEE 1	BPS	DAYS	BASIC PAY	ALLOWANCES	ARREARS	GROSS	DEDUCTIONS	NET PAY	
☐	AE Amina Example Lecturer	17	28 / 30	30,000	15,000	2,000	47,000	7,500	39,500	>
☐	BE Bilal Example Lecturer	17	30 / 30	32,000	15,000	0	47,000	3,000	44,000	>
☐	Dania Example									

All amounts in PKR · Click an employee to view details

refresh

- 1 Checkboxes - Select individual staff. The top checkbox selects the rows currently visible in the list.
- 2 Employee name - Click the name or row arrow to open that person's monthly form.
- 3 Days - The first number is days worked; the second is working days for the month.
- 4 Deductions - The total includes CPF, loan instalment, unpaid-day deduction and other deduction.
- 5 Net pay - The amount remaining after deductions. Red negative pay needs review.
- 6 Refresh - Reload saved payroll data. Gross, allowances and arrears columns show the earnings breakdown.

Searching does not automatically limit an export. Tick the people you need, then explicitly choose Selected employees.

Edit one month without changing the master

Click a person in Payroll. The form heading identifies the selected month.

1 Changes apply only to this month. Employee master records stay unchanged.

Personal details

Full name
Amina Example

Designation
Lecturer

Appointment date
01.08.2024

BPS (blank for contract)
17

Section
Senior College

Bank & contact details

Bank account number
DEMO-001

Bank
Sample Bank

Email address
teacher1@example.invalid

CPF account number
CPF-001

CPF member
Yes

- 1** Monthly-only notice - Edits here are saved for this month. The Employees master record stays unchanged.
- 2** Bank account number - A correction here applies to this month's reports only.
- 3** Bank - Check the bank name together with the account number.
- 4** Email address - This month's saved email is used when its payslip is sent.
- 5** CPF member - Choose whether the CPF deduction applies in this month.

You can also edit name, designation, appointment date, BPS, section and CPF account here. Scroll down for salary inputs. Locked months open read-only.

Enter days, earnings and deductions

Scroll inside the employee form to reach Attendance & salary inputs.

Attendance & salary inputs

Working days 1	Days worked 2
30	28
Running basic 3	House rent
30000	5000
Conveyance	Medical
4000	1000
Adhoc allowance 4	Special allowance
3000	2000
Arrears / encashment	CPF deduction 5
2000	3000
Loan instalment	Other deduction 6
1000	500

- 1** Working days - Enter the payroll basis for the month: 1 to 31 days.
- 2** Days worked - Enter 0 up to the working-days number. Fewer days produce an unpaid-day deduction.
- 3** Basic and allowances - Review running basic, house rent, conveyance, medical and special allowance.
- 4** Adhoc allowance - Enter a fixed amount. A label mentioning a percentage does not calculate that percentage.
- 5** CPF deduction - Enter the employee's fund deduction. It is applied only when CPF member is Yes.
- 6** Other deduction - Enter an additional deduction. Arrears add pay; loan instalment reduces pay.

New months use master/BPS defaults. Last month's arrears and loan instalment do not automatically repeat.

Understand the net-pay preview

This example matches Amina Example in the training screenshots. It is an illustration of the app's calculation.

The screenshot shows a payroll calculation interface. At the top, there are four input fields: 'Arrears / encumbrance' (value 2000), 'CPF deduction' (value 3000), 'Loan instalment' (value 1000), and 'Other deduction' (value 500). Below these is a summary table with the following data:

Gross salary	Rs 47,000
Leave deduction	Rs 3,000
Total deductions	Rs 7,500
Estimated net pay	Rs 39,500

At the bottom of the table, there is a note: 'Preview only. Save to apply changes to the payroll.' Below the table are two buttons: 'Close' and 'Save changes' (with a green checkmark icon). Numbered callouts are placed over the interface: 1 points to the 'Arrears / encumbrance' field, 2 points to the 'Loan instalment' field, 3 points to the 'Total deductions' row in the table, and 4 points to the 'Save changes' button.

Basic + allowances

$$30,000 + 15,000 = 45,000$$

Gross salary

$$45,000 + 2,000 \text{ arrears} = 47,000$$

Unpaid days

$$30 \text{ working days} - 28 \text{ worked} = 2$$

Leave deduction

$$45,000 / 30 \times 2 = 3,000$$

Total deductions

$$3,000 \text{ CPF} + 1,000 \text{ loan} + 3,000 \text{ leave} + 500 \text{ other} = 7,500$$

Net pay

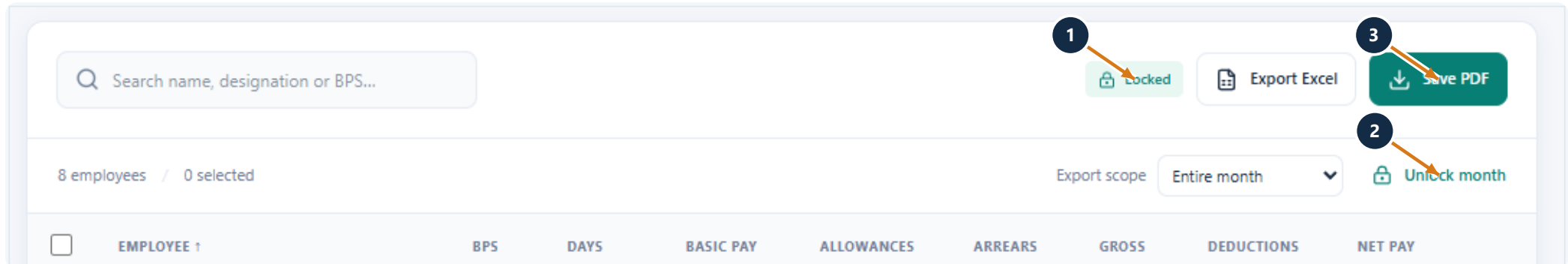
$$47,000 - 7,500 = 39,500$$

- 1 Arrears - Extra pay added this month.
- 2 Loan instalment - This month's loan deduction.
- 3 Preview - Updates as you change inputs.
- 4 Save changes - Applies the form to payroll.

Arrears are not included in the unpaid-day deduction basis. The app uses whole rupees. A preview is not saved until you click Save changes.

Lock the final figures

Use locking after you have checked the month, staff list and salary totals.



1 Check the status

Draft means payroll can change.

Locked means the saved salary snapshot is used. Monthly details become read-only and later master pay changes do not change these locked figures.

2 Unlock only for a correction

Click Unlock month and read the confirmation.

Unlocking removes the final snapshot and recalculates with current master data and monthly inputs. Recheck the amounts before locking again.

3 Use the final reports

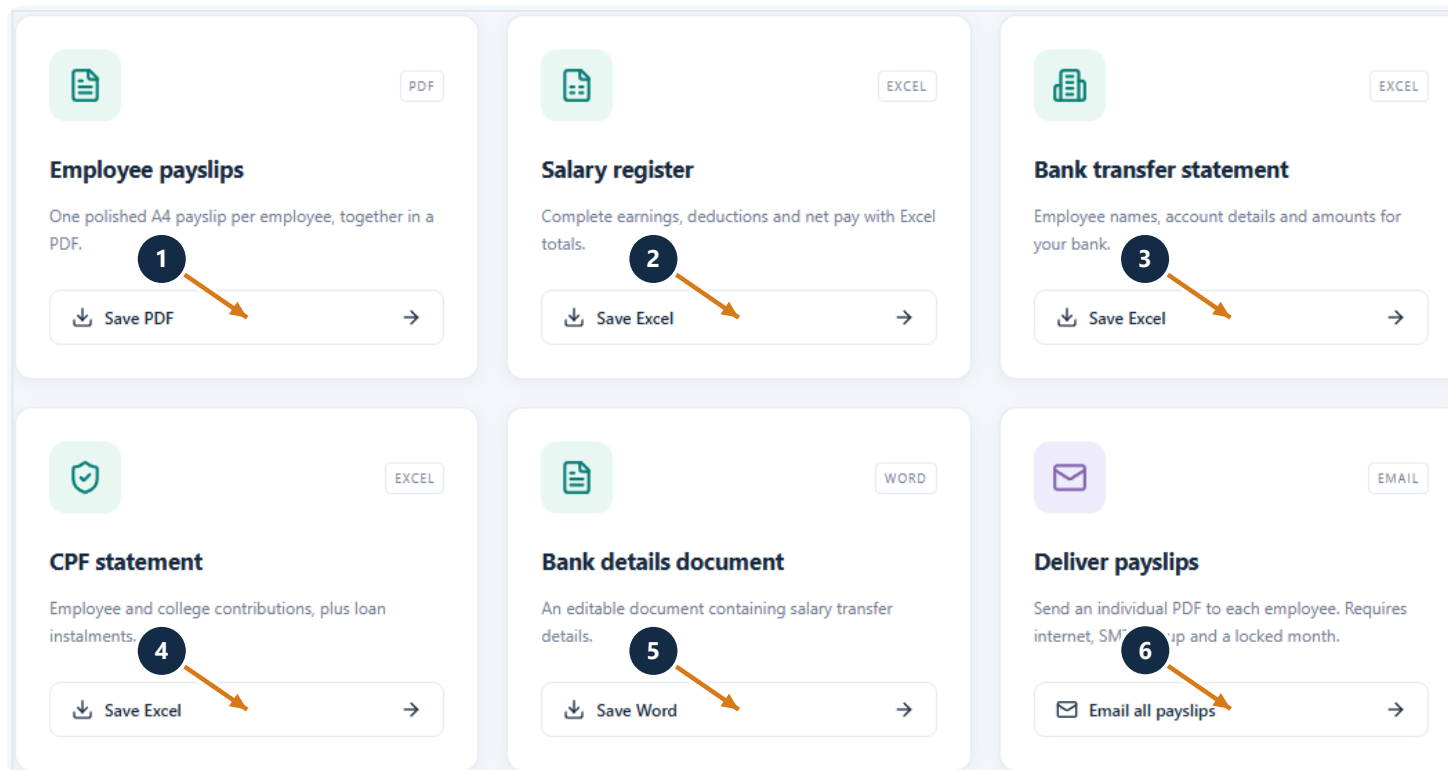
Click Save PDF or open Reports.

Locking does not send email, transfer money or create a backup. It preserves the payroll figures. College headings still use current Settings.

An empty payroll or a negative net salary cannot be finalized. Fix invalid days and amounts, save the changes, then try again.

Choose the right report

Select the month and export scope first. Each card creates a different file.

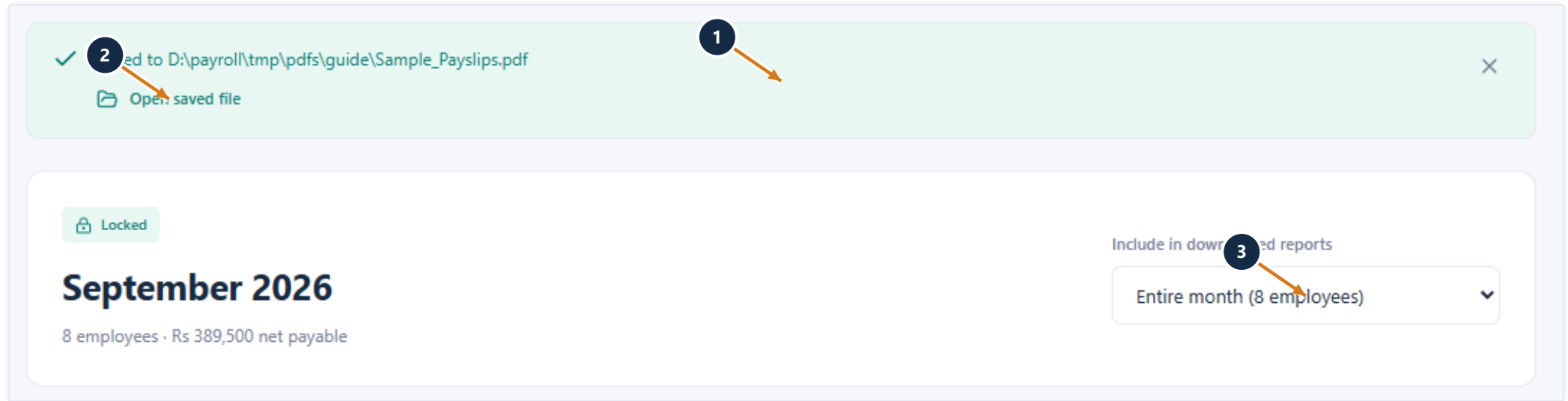


- 1 Employee payslips - PDF - One A4 page per employee, combined in one PDF.
- 2 Salary register - Excel - Detailed earnings, deductions and totals.
- 3 Bank transfer statement - Excel - Names, bank accounts, banks and net salaries.
- 4 CPF statement - Excel - Employee contribution, college contribution and loan instalment.
- 5 Bank details document - Word - An editable bank-details document.
- 6 Deliver payslips - Email - Sends individual PDFs. Needs internet, email settings and a locked month.

A bank statement is a document only. Payroll Desk does not transfer money or connect to your bank account.

Save a file, then open or print it

The same save workflow applies to PDF, Excel and Word reports.



- 1 Saved message - After the report finishes, check the folder and file name shown in the green message.
- 2 Open saved file - Open the report in the default Windows viewer. To print a PDF, use that viewer's Print command.
- 3 Report scope - Entire month includes everyone. Selected employees uses the checkboxes on Payroll.

Click a Save button, choose a folder in the Windows save box, enter a file name and click Save. Cancel closes the box without creating a report.

Set up your college and payslips

Changes are stored when you click Save settings. Set logo accepts a PNG image.

College & payroll preferences
These defaults apply where no monthly override is saved.

1 **Set logo**

2 **College name (shown on the salary sheet)**
Sample College - Training

3 **Working days in a month (default)**
30

4 **CPF: college contribution, % of employee's deduction**
100

Payslip wording for the adhoc / increase line
Adhoc allowance (fixed amount)

Bank name (used when an employee has none entered)
ABL

CPF statement voucher prefix (e.g. BCZC)
BCZC

Payslip heading (college, campus, phone)
Sample College | Training copy

Payslip signatory name
Accounts Officer

Payslip signatory designation
Finance Office

5 **Save settings**

Adhoc allowances are fixed BPS amounts; the payslip wording does not calculate a percentage.

- 1 Set logo - Choose the college logo for future payslips.
- 2 College name and heading - Set the salary-sheet name and payslip heading. Add the signatory name and title below.
- 3 Working days - Set the default payroll days. Check the actual month before calculating salary.
- 4 College CPF contribution - This percentage is based on the employee's CPF deduction, not basic pay. 100% means an equal contribution.
- 5 Save settings - Save after editing. Default bank and voucher prefix are also set on this page.

The adhoc/increase field changes payslip wording only. The actual adhoc amount comes from BPS or the monthly salary inputs.

Manage BPS allowance amounts

These are fixed amounts for a grade. Basic salary is entered separately for each employee.

Fixed allowances by grade
Running basic and special allowance are entered per employee.

BPS	HOUSE RENT	CONVEYANCE	MEDICAL	ADHOC	CPF	
16	4,000	3,000	800	2,500	2,500	Edit grade >

Grade & monthly amounts

BPS grade:

House rent:

Conveyance:

Medical:

Adhoc allowance:

CPF deduction:

[Delete grade](#) [Close](#) [Save changes](#)

- 1 Add grade - Create a new grade and enter its monthly amounts.
- 2 Edit grade - Open an existing grade. Keep its BPS number unless you intend to add a different grade.
- 3 Allowance fields - Set house rent, conveyance, medical and adhoc. Use amounts, not percentage formulas.
- 4 CPF deduction - Set the employee deduction for members of this grade.
- 5 Delete grade - Removes that grade. People using its defaults may lose those allowances in unlocked months.
- 6 Save changes - Save the grade. Monthly overrides stay as entered; locked salary figures stay fixed.

With no BPS, grade allowances are not added automatically. Running basic, special allowance and any explicitly entered monthly amounts can still apply.

Set up email, then send payslips

Use the details supplied by your email provider or IT team. Example addresses in this guide do not work.

Payslip email settings

Use your provider's SMTP credentials. Leave the password blank to keep the saved password.

1

Email SMTP server (e.g. smtp.gmail.com)

2

Email SMTP port (usually 587)

3

Email username / login

4

Email password / app password

5

From email address (leave blank to use username)

6

✓ Save settings

Email is optional. All other payroll functions work without internet.

1 SMTP server - The server used to send email. Enter your provider's value.

2 SMTP port - Use the provider's STARTTLS port, usually 587.

3 Username / login - The login name for the sending mailbox.

4 Password / app password - Enter the correct credential. A blank field keeps the saved password.

5 From email address - The sender address. Leave blank to use the username.

6 Save settings - Then lock the month, open Reports and choose Email all payslips.

Confirm the send count. Staff without an email are skipped. Email sends to the whole month, not the report selection. Review sent/failed results before retrying.

Back up, restore or move to another PC

A database backup contains employees, settings, monthly inputs and locked payroll figures.



A safe copy, whenever you need it.

Save a database backup to another drive. It contains employee records, salary inputs, locked figures and settings, including saved email credentials. Keep it private.

1  **Create backup**

3 

YOUR LOCAL DATA FOLDER

D:\payroll\tmp\pdfs\guide\training-data



Move or restore your records.

Choose a Payroll Desk database backup. Your current database is backed up automatically before replacement. Saved report files and logo images are separate from the database.

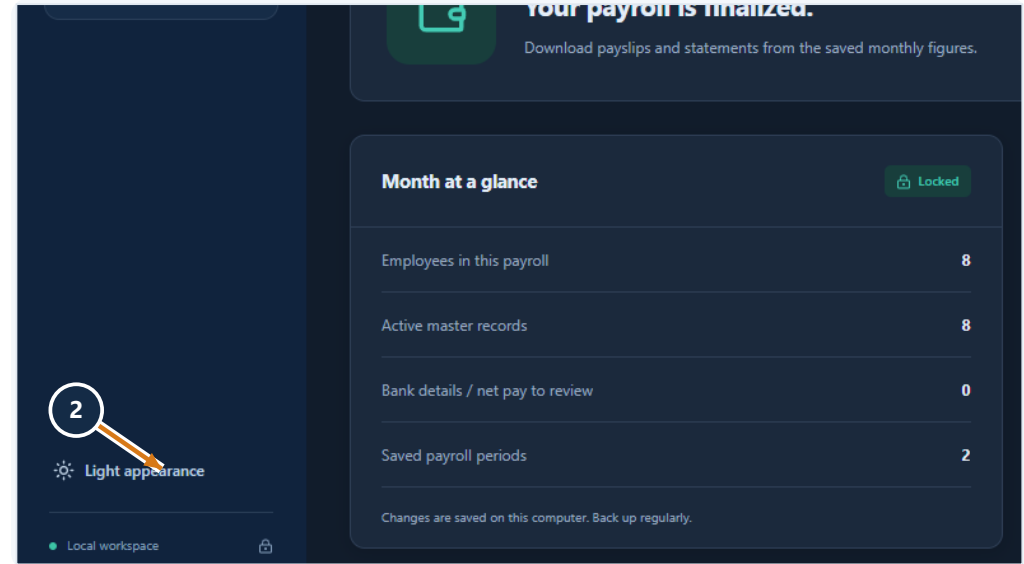
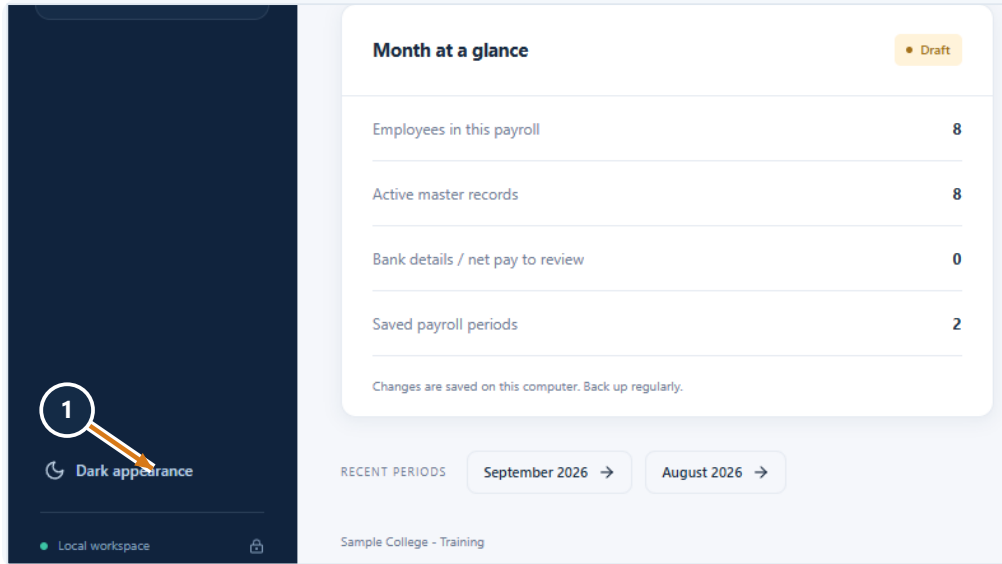
2  **Restore backup**

- 1** Create backup - Choose another drive or safe folder and save the .db file. Do this regularly.
- 2** Restore backup - Replaces current data with the chosen backup. A safety copy is made before replacement.
- 3** Your local data folder - Shows where the application keeps its working database on this computer.

On another Windows PC: install Payroll Desk, open Settings, then Restore backup. Exported reports and logo.png are separate; copy reports and set the logo again.

Choose a comfortable appearance

The theme changes the screen colors. It does not change salaries or the report files.



LIGHT APPEARANCE

- 1 Dark appearance - Click the moon button at the bottom of the sidebar to switch to dark colors.

DARK APPEARANCE

- 2 Light appearance - Click the sun button to return to light colors. Your choice is remembered on this computer.

If a section does not fit, scroll the page or the table. Employee forms have their own scroll area. Resize the window for a wider view.

Salary words in plain English

These meanings explain the fields used by this application.

Master record

An employee's usual details and pay defaults, edited in Employees.

Monthly record

Details or amounts saved for one selected month.

BPS

The grade used to look up fixed allowance and CPF amounts.

Running basic

The employee's base salary before allowances.

Allowance

Extra pay, such as house rent, conveyance, medical or special allowance.

Adhoc allowance

A fixed additional amount. The wording does not create a percentage formula.

Arrears / encashment

An extra amount added to gross pay for the month.

Gross salary

Basic + allowances + arrears, before deductions.

CPF / CP Fund

The employee's contributory provident fund deduction.

College contribution

The college's additional CPF amount. It is not deducted again from net salary.

Loan instalment

The repayment amount deducted this month; this app does not track a loan balance.

Leave without pay

The deduction calculated when worked days are fewer than working days.

Other deduction

Another entered deduction, such as a separately approved adjustment.

Net salary / net payable

Gross salary minus CPF, loan, unpaid-day and other deductions.

Draft / Locked

Draft can recalculate. Locked uses saved final payroll figures.

Backup / Export

Backup saves the database. Export creates a PDF, Excel or Word report.

Your monthly desk checklist

Work through the left side each month. Use the right side when something needs attention.

BEFORE YOU FINISH

- ☐ **Choose the correct month**
Check the period before editing or exporting.
- ☐ **Check the staff list**
Confirm active staff and bank/account details.
- ☐ **Enter the monthly changes**
Days worked, arrears, allowances and deductions.
- ☐ **Save every edited form**
A calculation preview alone does not save data.
- ☐ **Review the totals**
Check unusual deductions and negative net pay.
- ☐ **Lock the month**
Preserve the figures after your review.
- ☐ **Save the reports**
Check Entire month versus Selected employees.
- ☐ **Back up the database**
Keep a private copy on another drive.

QUICK FIXES

The employee list looks empty

Clear the search. On Employees, try Show inactive. Check the month and whether records were imported or restored.

I cannot edit the monthly form

The month may be locked. Unlock only if a correction is intended, then review and lock it again.

The export is empty or incomplete

Check the export scope. Selected employees needs checked rows. A search alone does not set the report scope.

The file will not save or open

Close it in Excel or the PDF viewer, choose a writable folder and retry. A viewer is needed to open the saved file.

Email failed

Check internet, SMTP details and employee email addresses. Review results before retrying to avoid duplicate emails.

My old and new apps show different data

Use the new Payroll Desk shortcut. Run Legacy Payroll.cmd opens the old app, whose database is separate.